

 **India's G20 presidency is a watershed moment, with the country helping shape a number of global issues. Among them are the reform of multilateral development banks, the inclusion of the African Union and the focus on climate action. As the central figure taking forward the G20 this year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has successfully ensured that India plays a pivotal role in addressing the concerns of the Global South.**

In an exclusive, over 40-minute-long interaction with *Business Today* at his sprawling, tastefully done up office in 7, Lok Kalyan Marg just days before the G20 Leaders' Summit, Modi—dressed immaculately and looking very relaxed—speaks passionately about the opportunity India has to help address areas of global concern, how the country's digital public infrastructure has become the toast of the world, India as a potential manufacturing hub, and much more.

Q: India's presidency of the G20 comes at a time when international agencies are bullish about the growth potential of the Indian economy. In your view how will the G20 summit help bolster India's image as an emerging economic power and as a credible voice at global economic platforms?

A: I don't think the image of a country and its branding can be bolstered through a summit. The financial world works on hard facts. It works on performance and not perception.

Whether it is the way India fought the Covid-19 pandemic and helped other countries to do so, or the way we managed our economy to make it the fastest growing, or the way our financial and banking systems have been going from strength to strength, today, the world is aware of India's trajectory. So, to see a summit through the prism of image building undermines the India growth story.

The G20 summit should be seen in a global context. During and after the Covid-19 pandemic, the world has gone through a lot of turbulence and naturally, the G20

group of countries has also felt concerned.

The G20 countries also felt that just talking about billions and trillions doesn't create impact and there should be focus on human-centric development.

My experience is that discussions have been going on these lines during our G20 presidency. In so many meetings and discussions, we have seen a shift from old positions, giving way to new perspectives.

Developed countries and developing countries will come together for the first time and find solutions to global problems. We have laid the foundation for inclusivity by inviting the African Union.

The extent of participation in our G20 presidency has been unprecedented and the openness of participants has been unparalleled. I am confident that this will lead to success, enabled by the contributions of all countries.

India and India's G20 will act as a catalytic agent for the new global order.

Q: Your government has invested a lot of energy in shaping India's G20 presidency. What are the key outcomes you hope to achieve at the end of India's presidency?

A: I am thankful to you for seeing India's efforts. Today, in the absence of reforms, multilateral institutions are losing credibility and trust all around the world. On the other hand, many smaller groups are emerging.

The world is looking at how G20 is shaping up to fill the vacuum existing today in terms of multilateral institutions. The world is looking at G20 to emerge as a driving force in the world and help shape policies which shape the future of humanity. The G20 group is being looked at as a ray of hope by the world and the ground for this is being laid during India's presidency of G20. The work that has happened and the outcomes expected are all futuristic.

This G20 is reflecting the voice and concerns of the Global South. This G20 is giving momentum to women-led development. When technology is going to play a big role in the future, this G20 is taking huge leaps in the fields of AI and DPI [digital public infrastructure].

India's G20 presidency will contribute towards One Earth in the form of path-breaking green initiatives.

India's G20 presidency will contribute towards One Family in the form of historic efforts aimed at inclusive and holistic growth.

India's G20 presidency will contribute towards One Future by reflecting the voice and concerns of the Global South as well as taking huge leaps in co-operation in the field of technology in the form of AI and DPI.